

(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Ferguson et al.

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(54) **STRAWBERRY PLANT NAMED**
‘DRISSTRAWTWENTYSIX’

(50) Latin Name: *Fragaria×ananassa*
Varietal Denomination: **DrisStrawTwentySix**

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patent is extended or adjusted under 35
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A01H 5/00 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.** **Plt./208**

(58) **Field of Classification Search** Plt./208
See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct variety of strawberry plant named ‘Dris-
StrawTwentySix’ characterized by having large, conical fruit
with medium sweetness and high yield is disclosed.

3 Drawing Sheets

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Genus and species: *Fragaria×ananassa*.

Variety denomination: ‘DrisStrawTwentySix’.

BACKGROUND OF THE NEW PLANT

The present invention relates to a new and distinct straw-
berry variety designated ‘DrisStrawTwentySix’ and botani-
cally known as *Fragaria×ananassa*. This new strawberry
variety was discovered in Ventura County, Calif. in January
2007 and originated from a cross between the proprietary
female parent ‘18L33’ (unpatented) and the proprietary male
parent ‘193M68’ (unpatented). A single plant was selected for
asexual propagation via tissue culture and vegetative cuttings
in Shasta County, Calif. in 2007.

‘DrisStrawTwentySix’ underwent further testing in Ven-
tura County, Calif. for five years (2007-2011). The present
invention has been found to retain its distinctive characteris-
tics through successive asexual propagations via stolons.

Plant Breeder’s Rights for this variety have not been
applied for. ‘DrisStrawTwentySix’ has not been made pub-
licly available or sold more than one year prior to the filing
date of this application.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following are the most outstanding and distinguishing
characteristics of this new cultivar when grown under normal
horticultural practices in Ventura County, Calif.

1. High yield;
2. Large, conic shaped fruit; and
3. Very early harvest maturity.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying color photographs show typical speci-
mens of the new variety at various stages of development. The
colors shown are as true as can be reasonably obtained by
conventional photographic procedures. The photographs
were taken from six-month-old plants.

FIG. 1 shows overall plant habit including fruit at various
stages of development.

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FIG. 2 shows upper and lower surfaces of the leaves of the
plant with three leaflets.

FIG. 3 shows both upper and lower surfaces of the flowers.

FIG. 4 shows the whole fruit.

FIG. 5 shows the fruit in longitudinal cross-section.

DESCRIPTION OF THE NEW VARIETY

The following detailed descriptions set forth the distinctive
characteristics of ‘DrisStrawTwentySix’. The data which
define these characteristics is based on observations taken in
Ventura County, Calif. from 2007 to 2011. This description is
in accordance with UPOV terminology. Color designations,
color descriptions, and other phenotypical descriptions may
deviate from the stated values and descriptions depending
upon variation in environmental, seasonal, climatic, and cul-
tural conditions. ‘DrisStrawTwentySix’ has not been
observed under all possible environmental conditions. The
botanical description of ‘DrisStrawTwentySix’ was taken
from six-month-old plants. Color terminology follows The
Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart (R.H.S.), London
(2001 edition). Descriptive terminology follows the *Plant
Identification Terminology, An Illustrated Glossary*, 2nd edi-
tion by James G. Harris and Melinda Woolf Harris, unless
where otherwise defined.

**DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION OF THE
PLANT**

Classification:

Species.—*Fragaria×ananassa*.

Common name.—Strawberry.

Denomination.—‘DrisStrawTwentySix’.

Parentage:

Female parent.—The proprietary variety ‘18L33’ (un-
patented).

Male parent.—The proprietary variety ‘193M68’ (un-
patented).

Plant:

Height.—16.0 cm.

Diameter.—33.3 cm.

Number of crowns/plant.—3.

Habit.—Flat globose.
Density of individual plant.—Medium.
Vigor (health and hardiness of plant).—Medium.

Terminal leaflets:
Size.—Small. Length: 6.8 cm. Width: 5.9 cm. Length/width ratio: 1.2 (Longer than broad).
Number of teeth/terminal leaflet.—20.
Shape of teeth.—Obtuse-senate to crenate.
Color.—Upper surface: RHS 139A (Dark green).
 Lower surface: RHS 148C (Light yellow-green).
Shape in cross section.—Concave.
Blistering.—Medium.
Glossiness.—Strong.
Number of leaflets.—Three only.
Shape.—Oval.
Base shape.—Slightly oblique.
Apex descriptor.—Convex.
Variegation.—Absent.
Margin.—Senate.
Margin profile.—Flat (level with the leaflet blade).

Petiole:
Length.—11.6 cm.
Diameter.—3.43 mm.
Pubescence.—Medium.
Pose of hairs.—Outwards-horizontal.
Color.—RHS 144C (Medium yellow-green).

Petiolule:
Length.—4.97 mm.
Diameter.—1.49 mm.
Bract frequency.—0.
Color.—RHS 144C (Medium yellow-green).

Stipule:
Length.—3.1 cm.
Width.—8.73 mm.
Pubescence.—Medium.
Anthocyanin coloration.—Weak; RHS 51D (Light red).

Stolon:
Number.—Medium.
Average number of daughter plants per plant.—82.
Anthocyanin coloration.—Medium; RHS 35A (Medium orange-red).
Thickness.—Thick.
Pubescence.—Medium.

Inflorescence:
Position relative to foliage.—Above.
Number of flowers.—Many.
Time of flowering (50% of plants at first flower).—Very early.
Flower size.—Large.
Flower diameter.—33.56 mm.
Petals.—Shape: Orbicular. Apex: Rounded. Base: Concave-convex. Margin: Entire. Spacing: Overlapping. Length: 17.86 mm. Width: 17.00 mm. Length/width ratio: As long as broad; 1.1. Typical and observed petal number per flower: 6. Color (upper surface): RHS 155B (White).
Calyx.—Diameter: 46.93 mm. Diameter relative to corolla: Larger. Inner calyx diameter relative to outer: Smaller. Insertion of calyx: Level. Pose of calyx segments: Reflexed — upwards. Size of calyx in relation to fruit: Slightly larger. Adherence of calyx: Strong.
Sepal.—Shape: Elliptical. Apex: Convex. Margin: Entire. Length: 20.04 mm. Width: 7.28 mm. Typical and observed sepal number per flower: 13.
Receptacle color.—RHS 1B (Medium green-yellow).

Stamen.—Present. Anther color: RHS 15A (Medium yellow-orange).
Pedicel.—Attitude of hairs: Upwards.

Fruiting truss:
Length.—Long; 17.3 cm.
Diameter at base of truss.—2.51 mm.
Number of berries per fruiting truss.—3.
Attitude at first picking.—Prostrate.
Color at base of truss.—RHS 144A (Medium yellow-green).

Fruit:
Relative fruit size.—Large.
Length.—55.47 mm.
Width.—45.30 mm.
Length/width ratio.—1.2 (Longer than broad).
Fruit hollow length.—27.47 mm.
Fruit hollow width.—11.35 mm.
Fruit hollow length/width ratio.—2.4.
Fruit hollow center (size).—Large.
Weight (per individual berry).—30.0 g.
Predominant fruit shape.—Conical.
Difference in shape between primary and secondary fruits.—Slight.
Evenness of fruit surface.—Even or very slightly uneven.
Fruit skin color.—RHS 46A (Dark red).
Evenness of fruit color.—Even or very slightly uneven.
Fruit glossiness.—Medium.
Achenes.—Insertion of achenes: Below surface. Coloration (sunward side of berry): RHS 179B (Medium greyed-red). Coloration (shaded side of berry): RHS 153D (Medium yellow-green). Number per berry: 365. Weight (weight achenes divided by total # seed): 0.000548602. Width of band without achenes: Broad.
Firmness of flesh.—Medium.
Color of flesh (excluding core).—RHS 39B (Light red) and RHS 155A (White).
Color of core.—RHS 39B (Light red).
Evenness of flesh color.—Even.
Distribution of flesh color.—Marginal and central.
Sweetness.—Medium.
Acidity.—Medium.
Texture when tasted.—Medium.
Type of bearing.—Not everbearing — not remontant.
Grams of fruit/plant.—94.3 g.
Harvest interval.—December to July.
Harvest maturity.—Very early.

Disease, pest, and stress resistance:
Botrytis fruit rot.—Susceptible.
Powdery mildew.—Moderately susceptible.
Verticillium wilt.—Susceptible.
Xanthomonas fragariae.—Moderately susceptible.
Aphis spp. (Aphids).—Susceptible.
Lygus hesperus (Lygus bug).—Susceptible.
High temperatures.—Moderately susceptible.
Wind.—Moderately susceptible.
High pH.—Moderately resistant.
High soil salt levels.—Moderately resistant.

COMPARISON WITH PARENTAL AND COMMERCIAL VARIETIES

When 'DrisStrawTwentySix' is compared to the proprietary female parent '18L33' (unpatented), 'DrisStrawTwen-

tySix' has earlier fruit production and smaller sized fruit than '18L33' and is less vigorous than '18L33'.

When 'DrisStrawTwentySix' is compared to the proprietary male parent '193M68' (unpatented), 'DrisStrawTwentySix' has earlier fruit production, larger fruit size with better flavor, and higher total yields than '193M68' and is less vigorous and has firmer fruit than '193M68'.

When 'DrisStrawTwentySix' is compared to the commercial variety 'Driscoll El Dorado' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 16,238), 'DrisStrawTwentySix' has a medium density, flat globose habit that is not everbearing, with strongly glossy leaves and a slightly oblique terminal leaflet base, while 'Driscoll El Dorado' has a dense, globose habit that is partially everbearing, with medium glossy leaves and a rounded terminal leaflet base. Additionally, 'DrisStrawTwentySix' has thick stolons and a broad band without achenes, while 'Driscoll El Dorado' has thin stolons and a narrow to medium band without achenes.

When 'DrisStrawTwentySix' is compared to the commercial variety 'DrisStrawEight' (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 20,735), 'DrisStrawTwentySix' has a flat globose habit that is not everbearing, with strongly glossy leaves, a flat terminal leaflet margin and an oval terminal leaflet shape, while 'DrisStrawEight' has a globose habit that is partially everbearing, with weakly glossy leaves, a revolute terminal leaflet margin and an orbicular terminal leaflet shape. Additionally, 'DrisStrawTwentySix' has thick stolons and three berries per fruiting truss, while 'DrisStrawEight' has thin stolons and one berry per fruiting truss.

We claim:

1. A new and distinct variety of strawberry plant named 'DrisStrawTwentySix' as described and shown herein.

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FIG. 1

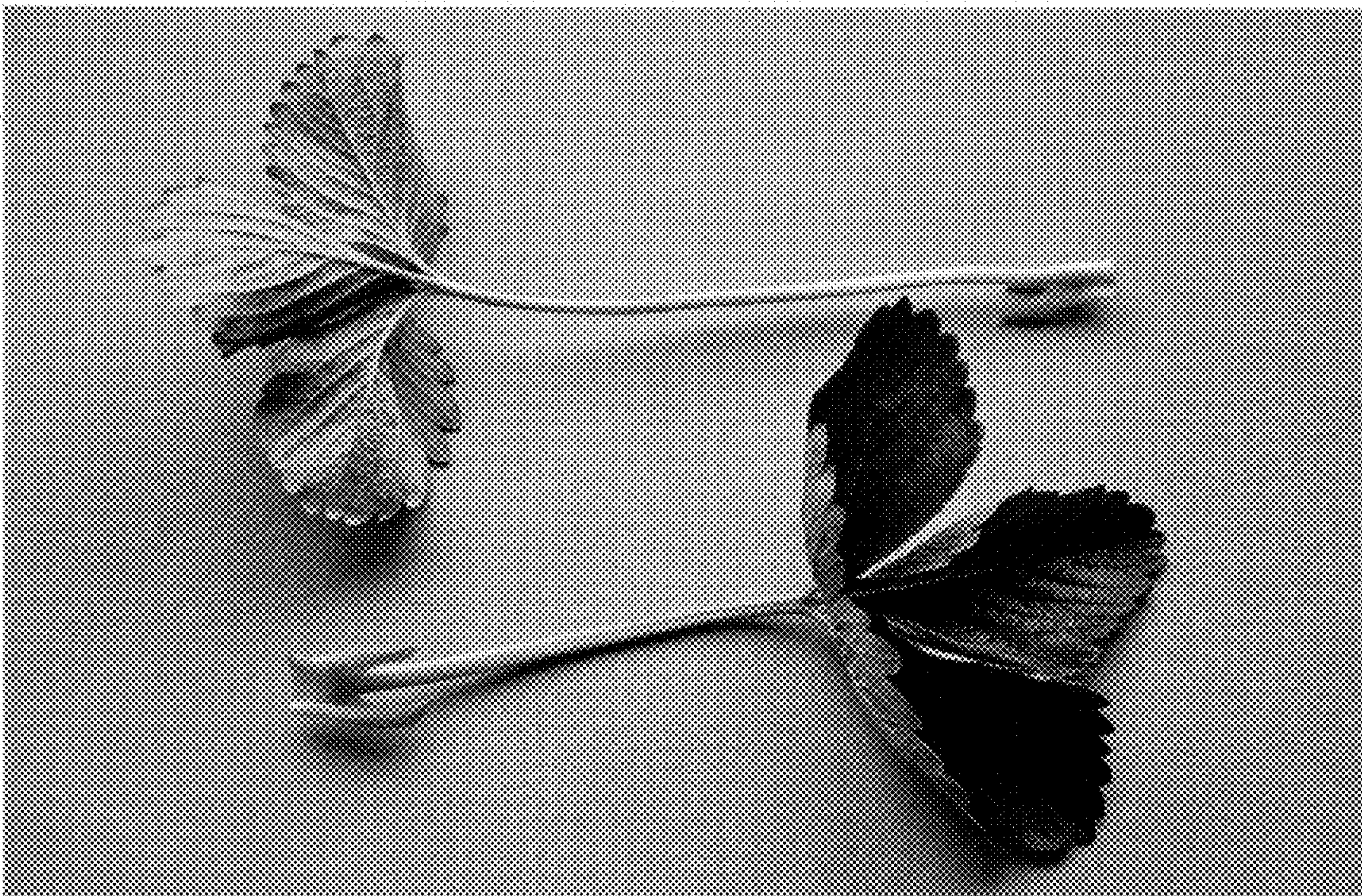


FIG. 2

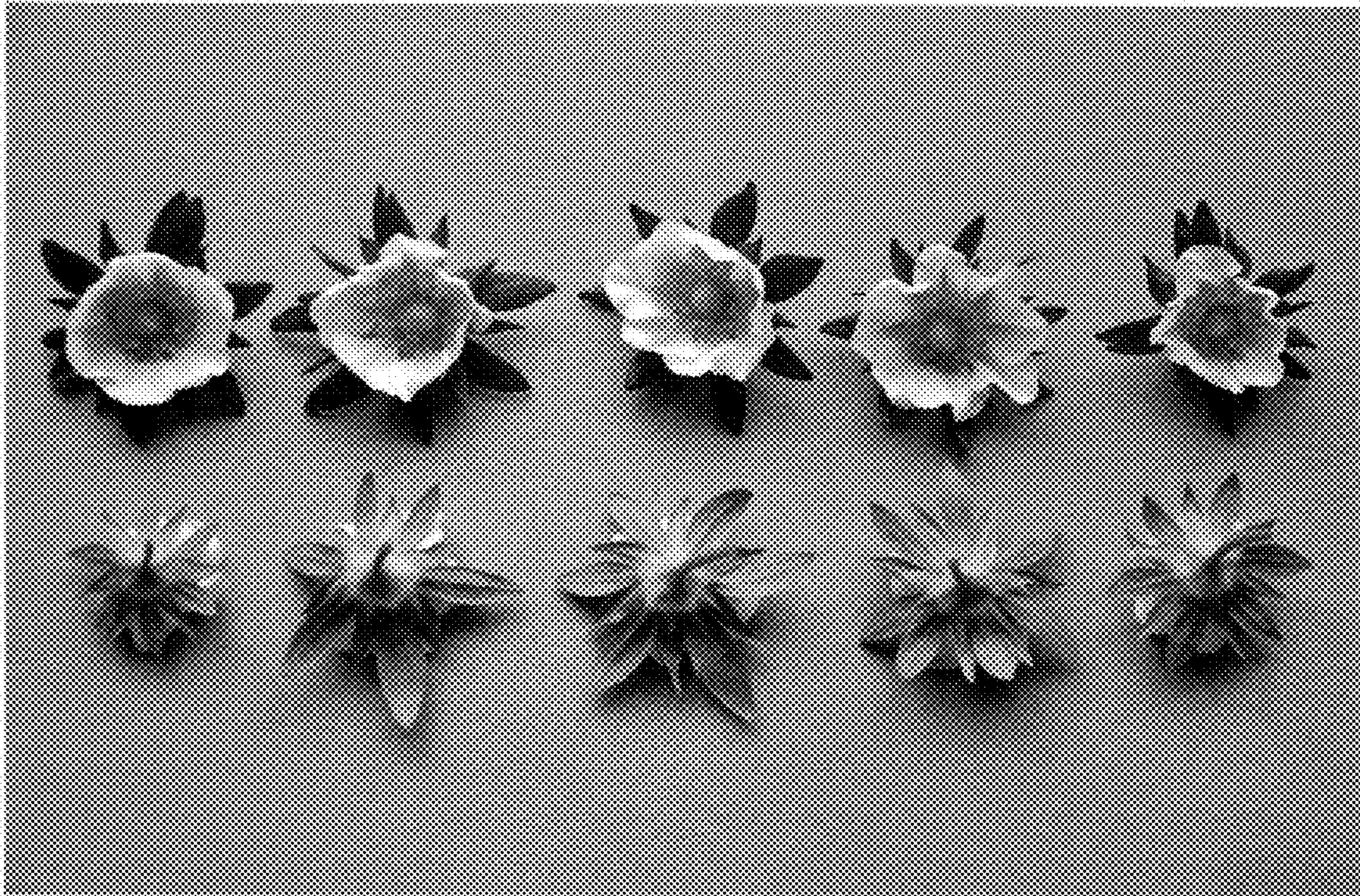


FIG. 3

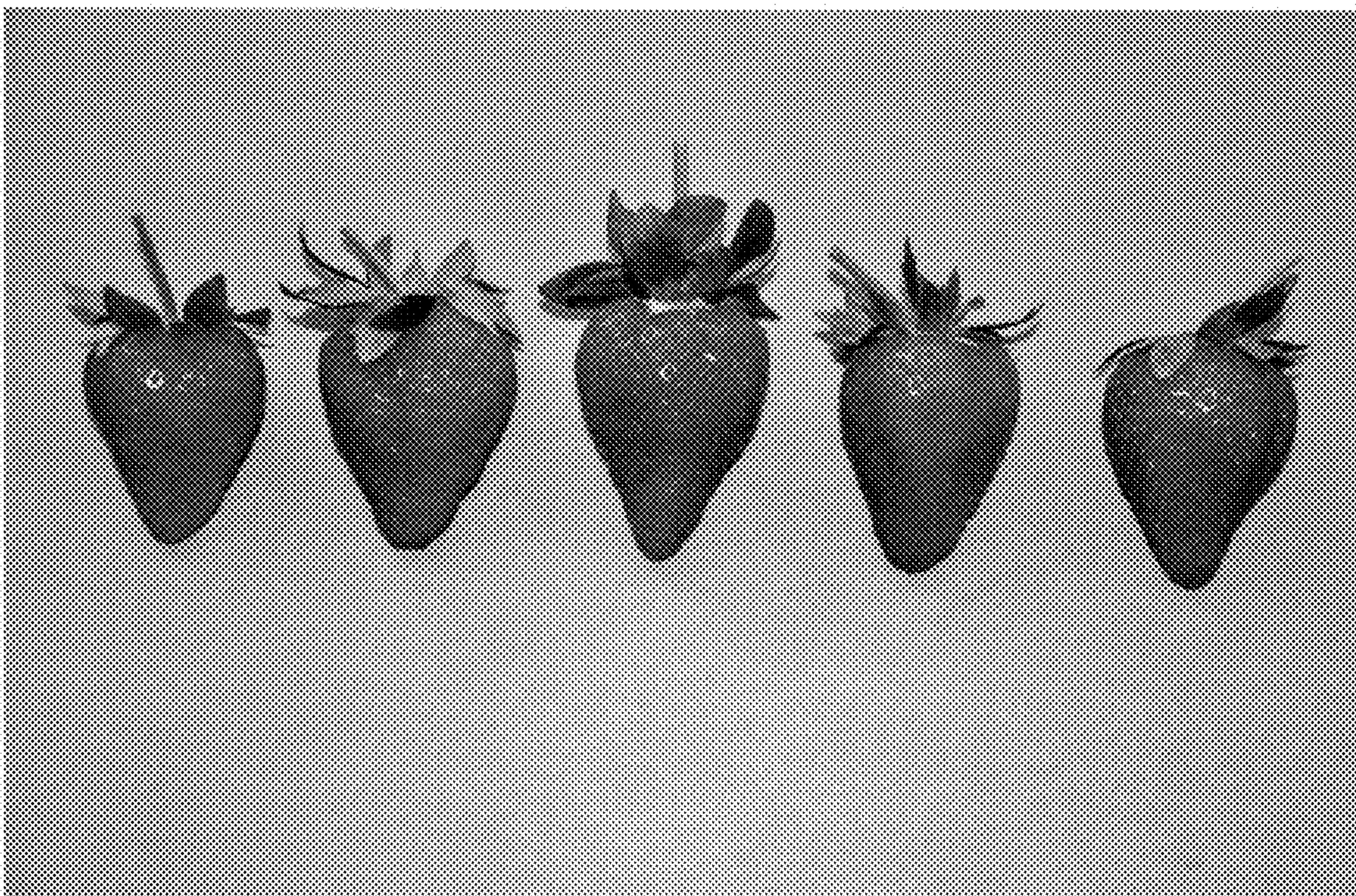


FIG. 4

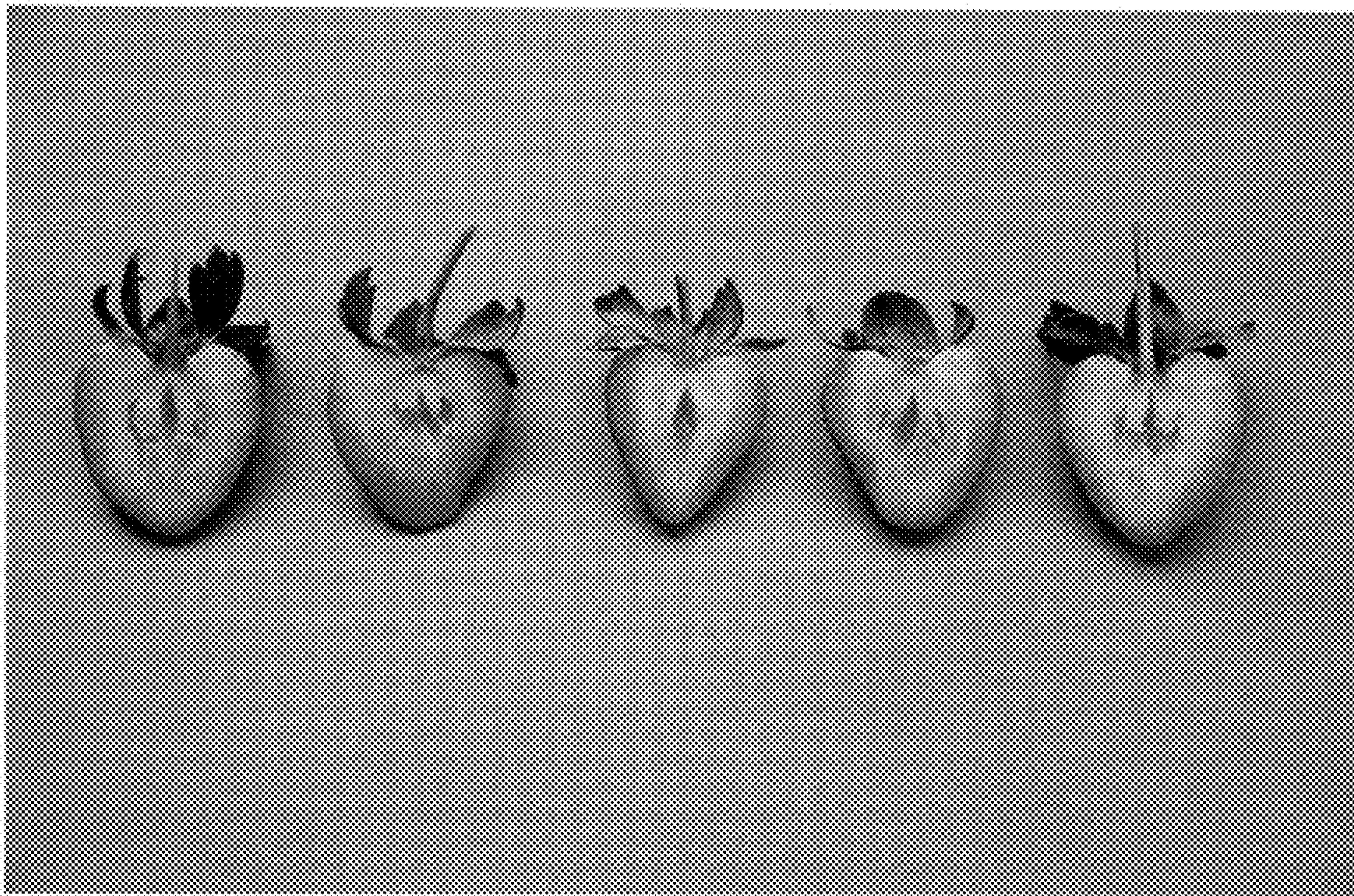


FIG. 5